

Unit -1 Introduction [6 Hrs.]

E-Governance

E-governance is the application of ICT to the processes of government functioning for good governance. In other words, e-governance is the public sector's use of ICTs with the aim to improve information and service delivery, encourage citizen participation in decision-making and make government more accountable, transparent and efficient.

With the use of e-Governance, the government services will be made available to the citizens in a convenient, efficient and transparent manner. The three main target groups that can be distinguished in governance concepts are Government, citizens and businesses. Generally four basic models are available-Government to Customer (Citizen), Government to Employees, Government to Government and Government to Business.

So in essence, e-governance is the application of ICT in government functioning to bring in **SMART governance implying: simple, moral, accountable, responsive and transparent governance.**

SMART GOVERNANCE

Simple- meaning simplification of rules, regulations and processes of government through the use of ICTs and thereby providing for a user-friendly government

Moral- connoting emergence of an entirely new system of ethical values in the political and administrative machinery. Technology interventions improve the efficiency of anti-corruption agencies, police, judiciary, etc.

Accountable- facilitating design, development and implementation of effective Management Information System and performance measurement mechanisms and thereby ensuring accountability of public service functionaries.

Responsive- streamlining the processes to speed up service delivery and make system more responsive.

Transparent- bringing information hitherto confined in the government documents to the public domain and making processes and functions transparent, which in turn would bring equity and rule of law in responses of the administrative agencies.

SMART governance, thus, helps in:

- improving the internal organisational processes of governments;
- providing better information and service delivery;
- increasing government transparency in order to reduce corruption;
- reinforcing political credibility and accountability; and
- promoting democratic practices through public participation and consultation.

E-Governance vs E-Government

e-Government refers to the implementation of information and communication technology (ICT) like internet, to improve government activities and process. e-Government aims of increasing transparency, efficiency and citizen involvement in the various government schemes, operations and process. Hence it speeds up the justice delivery system in the country.

1. **By e-Government we mean the use of ICT in government operations**, as a tool to increase the outreach of the government services. **e-Governance**, on the other hand, implies the **use of ICT in transforming and supporting functions and structures of the system**.
2. **e-Government is a system while e-Governance is a function.**
3. **e-Government is a one-way communication protocol. On the contrary, e-Governance is a two-way communication protocol.**

Key Differences:

- **Focus and Objectives:** E-government focuses on the **digitization of government services and improving administrative efficiency**, while **e-governance** focuses on **citizen engagement, transparency, and participatory decision-making**.
- **Stakeholder Involvement:** E-government primarily involves government agencies and citizens, **whereas e-governance encourages collaboration** between the government, citizens, businesses, and civil society organizations.
- **Relationship with Citizens:** E-government emphasizes **service delivery to citizens**, aiming to provide convenient and **accessible online services**. E-governance, on the other hand, **seeks to empower citizens and involve them in the governance process, giving them a voice in decision-making**.
- **Technological Emphasis:** E-government relies heavily on technology for online service delivery and process automation. E-governance also utilizes technology but focuses more on citizen engagement, transparency, and accountability through digital platforms.

WHY e-GOVERNANCE?

1. **To build an informed society** – An informed society is an empowered society. Only informed people can make a Government responsible. So providing access to all to every piece of information of the Government and of public importance is one of the basic objectives of E- Governance.
2. **To increase Government and Citizen interaction** - In the physical world, the Government and Citizens hardly interact. The amount of feedback from and to the citizens is very negligible. E- Governance aims at build a feedback framework, to get feedback from the people and to make the Government aware of people's problems.

3. **To encourage citizen participation** - True democracy requires participation of each individual citizen. Increased population has led to representative democracy, which is not democracy in the true sense. E-governance aims to restore democracy to its true meaning by improving citizen participation in the Governing process, by improving the feedback, access to information and overall participation of the citizens in the decision-making.
4. **To bring transparency in the governing process** - E-governance carries an objective to make the Governing process transparent by making all the Government data and information available to the people for access. It is to make people know the decisions, and policies of the Government.
5. **To make the Government accountable** - Government is responsible and answerable for every act decision taken by it. E-Governance aims and will help make the Government more accountable than now by bringing transparency's and making the citizens more informed.
6. **To reduce the cost of Governance** - E-Governance also aims to reduce cost of governance by cutting down on expenditure on physical delivery of information and services. It aims to do this by cutting down on stationary, which amounts to the most of the government's expenditure. It also does away with the physical communication thereby reducing the time required for communication while reducing cost.
7. **To reduce the reaction time of the Government** – Normally due to red tapism and other reasons, the Government takes long to reply to people's queries and problems. E-Governance aims to reduce the reaction time of the Government to the people's queries and problems, because 's problems are basically Government's problems as Government is for the people.

Advantages of E-Governance

1. **Speed** – Technology makes communication swifter. Internet, Phones, Cell Phones have reduced the time taken in normal communication.
2. **Cost Reduction** – Most of the Government expenditure is appropriated towards the cost of stationary. Paper-based communication needs lots of stationary, printers, computers, etc. which calls for continuous heavy expenditure. Internet and Phones makes communication cheaper saving valuable money for the Government.
3. **Transparency** – Use of ICT makes governing process transparent. All the information of the Government would be made available on the Internet. The citizens can see the information whenever they want. Current governing process leaves many ways to censor the information from all the people. ICT helps make the information available online eliminating all the possibilities of censoring of information.
4. **Accountability** – Once the governing process is made transparent the Government is automatically made accountable. Accountability is answerability of the Government to the people. It is the answerability for the deeds of the Government. An accountable Government is a responsible Government.

Needs of E-Governance

E-Governance seek to achieve

- Efficiency
- Transparency
- Citizen's participation

Enabling e-governance through ICT contributes to

- Good governance, Trust and Accountability
- Citizen's awareness, empowerment and Citizen's welfare
- Nation's economic growth
- Ensure transparent, timely and hassle free delivery of services.
- Provide greater public access to information and has proved to be a more efficient and cost-effective way of governance.
- E-Government can transform citizen service, provide access to information to empower citizens, enable their participation in government and enhance citizen economic and social opportunities, so that they can make better lives, for themselves and for the next generation.

Strategic Objectives of e-Governance

The strategic objective of e-governance is to support and simplify governance for all parties - government, citizens, businesses and its employees. The use of ICTs can connect all three parties and support processes and activities.

There may be two major objectives of e- governance:

1. Service to the Public: This objective of e-government is to satisfactorily fulfill the public's needs and expectations on the front-office side, by simplifying their interaction with various online services. The use of ICTs in government operations facilitates speedy, transparent, accountable, efficient and effective interaction with the public, citizens, business and other agencies.

2. Efficient Government: In the back-office, the objective of e-government in government operations is to facilitate a speedy, transparent, accountable, efficient and effective process for performing government administration activities. Significant cost savings in government operations can be the result.

Issues in E-Governance applications

A number of issues, some old and some new have arisen in e-governance application, for example:

- Lack of strategies and financial plan.
- The project implementation is generally vendor driven
- Lack of standardization (For example, similar projects are carried out by different state agencies using incompatible file formats and application standards)
- Reverse compatibility of application with legacy systems are missing in several projects.

- The IT Infrastructures are obtained just before building the application or digitizing the data.
- Physical security is emphasized, whereas the Logical and application security is left to vendors in many cases.
- Lack of understanding by the departments, for the components of e-governance applications, which can be outsourced or can be carried out in-house.

Phases in E-Governance

1. Phase 1: Information Technology framework
2. Phase 2: Digitization
3. Phase 3: Citizen Access
4. Phase 4: Content Development

In the first phase: Information Technology framework

The IT framework need to be identified and the project should be rolled out only after evaluating the feasibility of the project in terms of capacity building, readiness and financial sustainability.

Consequences: – If the project feasibility is not analyzed properly, the project could be the great failure, if it gets success by luck, it lead to delays and increased cost of the project

In the second phase: Digitization

The digitization is important to the success of the project. Large amount of data leads to mess and redundancy of the project. Before the digitization is initiated the data should be filtered. The data cleansing should be done periodically and only by the departments.

Problem: – The outsourced agency that is generally entrusted with this task is not the correct approach, since this leads to corruption, stealing and weakening of data.

In the third phase - Citizen Access:

To make the information available, the infrastructure plays a very vital role. The infrastructure includes telecommunication network, Electricity, Booths etc.

In the Fourth phase - Content Development:

This phase is not limited to content updating, but the transactions must be merged, scrutinized and updated. The transactional data must be converted into historical data and separate data mart may be created.

e-Governance Challenges

e-governance, however, is not really the use of IT in governance but as a tool to ensure good governance. e- governance does not mean proliferation of computers and accessories; it is basically a political decision which calls for discipline, attitudinal change in officers and employees, and massive government process re-engineering.

All implementers and drivers of e-governance initiatives agree that the biggest challenge of deploying e-governance is not technology but change management. Change management is important not only in terms of cultural change but also in terms of changing operations and processes workflow that the automated environment will introduce.

The key challenges with electronic governance are not technology or Internet issues but organizational issues like:

- Redefining rules and procedures
- Information transparency
- Legal issues
- Infrastructure, Skill and awareness
- Access to right information
- Interdepartmental collaboration
- Tendency to resist the change in work culture

e-Governance Challenges Specific to Nepal

- **Lack of Integrated Services:** Most of the eGovernance Services being offered by the governments are not integrated. This can mainly be attributed to ***Lack of Communication between different Departments***. So the information that resides with one department has no or very little meaning to some other department of Government.
- **Lack of Key Persons:** eGovernance projects lack key persons, not only from technological aspect, but from other aspects as well.
- **Different Languages:** A challenge due to the diversity of the country. It enforces need to do governance in local languages. Ensuring eGovernance in local language is a big task to achieve.
 - Success factors of e-Gov projects
 - *20% Technology*
 - *50% Process*
 - *20% Change Management*
 - *Rest is LUCK*

The Digital Divide

The digital divide refers to the gap between people who enjoy regular access to technology, (such as computers and their related functions like ability to get on the Internet), and those who do not have this access. There are many ways to look at or consider the digital divide. The divide separates the “haves and have-nots”.

A term, digital divide used to describe the difference between people who have access to and the resources to use new information and communication tools, such as the Internet, and people who do not have the resources and access to the technology. The term also describes the discrepancy between those who have the skills, knowledge and abilities to use the technologies and those who do not. The digital divide can exist between those living in rural areas and those living in urban areas, between the educated and uneducated, between economic classes, and on a global scale between more and less industrially developed nations.

Internet and computer use has undoubtedly increased in the urban areas of Nepal and the digital divide may be smaller within certain populations but the case is totally different on rural areas. It remains a fact that poorer people may not be able to afford technology, and poorly funded schools aren't always able to offer regular use of technology to their students. In contrast, students in middle class and upper class families, and in schools that have medium to excellent funding, may have technology at home and school. This gives them considerable advantages over those whose homes and schools don't have the same offerings.

Poorer nations are divided more from richer nations in this respect, and many argue that the wealth of information available to poorer nations through the Internet could help improve lives and put an end to poverty.

To this end there are many charitable and government run organizations that help to shrink the digital divide by providing computers or funding to get computers to individuals or educational institutions. They may address the divide in a specific country that is developing too. However, this can be problematic. In countries with severe poverty, many feel that first efforts should go toward providing clean water, medical care and food as needed instead of giving people technology access. Moreover, in areas that don't have electricity sources, digital materials can be relatively useless, and some argue trying to end the digital divide in extremely poor countries may not be possible until these countries achieve certain quality of living standards.

Conceptualization of the digital divide is often as follows:

- Subjects of connectivity, or who connects: individuals, organizations, enterprises, schools, hospitals, countries, etc.
- Characteristics of connectivity, or which attributes: demographic and socio-economic variables, such as income, education, age, geographic location, etc.
- Means of connectivity, or connectivity to what: fixed or mobile, Internet or telephony, digital TV, etc.
- Intensity of connectivity, or how sophisticated the usage: mere access, retrieval, interactivity, innovative contributions.
- Purpose of connectivity, or why individuals and their cohorts are (not) connecting: reasons individuals are and are not online and uses of the Internet and ICTs.

Scope (Possible Area) of e-Governance

e-Government is the use of information technologies(IT) in public administrations combined with organizational changes to improve public services.

Governance is all about flow of information between the Government and Citizens, Government and Businesses and Government and Government.

E-Governance also covers all these relationships as follows:

- A. Government to Citizen (G2C)
- B. Citizen to Government (C2G)
- C. Government to Government (G2G)
- D. Government to Business (G2B)

A. Government to Citizen

Government to Citizen relationship is the most basic aspect of E-Governance. In modern times, Government deals with many aspects of the life of a citizen. The relation of a citizen with the Government starts with the birth and ends with the death of the citizen. A person transacts with the Government on every corner of his life. It may be birth registration, marriage registration, divorce registration or death registration.

The G2C relation will include the services provided by the Government to the Citizens. These services include the public utility services i.e. Telecommunication, Transportation, Post, Medical facilities, Electricity, Education and also some of the democratic services relating to the citizenship such as Certification, Registration, Licensing, Taxation, Passports, ID Cards etc.

Therefore E-Governance in G2C relationship will involve facilitation of the services flowing from Government towards Citizens with the use of Information and Communications Technology (ICT).

1. E-Citizenship - E-Citizenship will include the implementation of ICT for facilitation of Government Services relating to citizenship of an individual. It may involve online transactions relating to issue and renewal of documents like *Ration Cards (India)*, *Passports*, *Election Cards*, *Identity Cards*, etc. It will require the Government to create a virtual identity of every citizen so as to enable them to access the Government services online. For the same, Government would need to create a Citizen Database, which is a huge task.

2. E-Registration - E-Registration will cover the online registration of various contracts. An individual enters into several contracts during his life. Many of these contracts and transactions require registration for giving it legality and enforceability. Such registration may also be made ICT enabled. E-registration will help to reduce a significant amount of paperwork.

3. E-Transportation - E-Transportation services would include ICT enablement of services of Government relating to Transport by Road, Rail, Water or Air. This may involve online –

1. booking and cancellation of tickets,
2. status of vehicles, railways, boats and flights,
3. issue and renewal of Driving Licenses,
4. registration and renewal of vehicles,
5. transfer of vehicles,
6. payment of the fees of licenses,
7. payment of fees and taxes for vehicle registration,

4. E-Health - E-Health services would be ICT enablement of the health services of the Government. Under this interconnection of all hospitals may take place. A patient database may be created. A local pharmacy database may also be created.

5. E-Education - E-Education would cover the implementation of ICT in imparting of education and conducting of Courses. Distant as well as classroom education will be facilitated with the use of ICT. Use of Internet can reduce the communication time required in Distance education; Internet may also help in conducting online classes.

6. E-Help - E-Help refers to facilitation of disaster and crisis management using ICT. It includes the use of technologies like Internet, SMS, etc. for the purpose of reducing the response time of the Government agencies to the disasters. NGOs help Government in providing help in situations of disasters. Online information relating to disasters, warnings and calls for help can help the Government and the NGOs coordinate their work and facilitate and speed up the rescue work.

7. E-Taxation - E-Taxation will facilitate the taxing process by implementing ICT in the taxing process. Online tax due alerts and online payment of taxes would help transact faster.

B. Citizen to Government

Citizen to Government relationship will include the communication of citizens with the Government arising in the Democratic process like voting, campaigning, feedback, etc.

1. E-Democracy - The true concept of Democracy includes the participation of the citizens in the democratic and governing process. Today due to the increased population the active participation of the citizens in governing process is not possible. The ICT can help enable the true democratic process including voting, public opinion, feedback and Government accountability.

2. E-Feedback - E-Feedback includes the use of ICT for the purpose of giving feedback to the Government. Lobbying is pursuing the Government to take a certain decision. Use of ICT can enable online feedback to the Government, online debates as to the Government services.

C. Government to Government

G2G relationship would include the relationships between Central and State Government and also the relationship between two or more Government departments.

1. E-administration - E-administration would include the implementation of ICT in the functioning of the Government, internally and externally. Implementation of ICT can reduce the communication time between the Government Departments and Governments. It can substantially reduce paperwork if properly used. E-administration will also bring morality and transparency to the administration of Government Departments.

2. E-police - The concept of E-police is little different from Cyber-Police. Cyber Police requires technology experts to curb the electronic/cyber crimes. E-police refers to the use of ICT for the purpose of facilitating the work of the Police department in investigation and administration. The concept of E-police includes databases of Police Officers, their performances, Criminal databases – wanted as well as in custody, the trends in crimes and much more. ICT can help reduce the response time of the Police department and also reduce cost by reducing paperwork.

3. E-courts - The concept of E-Court will include the ICT enablement of the judicial process. Technology may help distant hearing, online summons and warrants and online publication of Judgments and Decrees.

D. Government to Business

1. E-Taxation - Corporate sector pays many taxes, duties and dues to the Government. Payment of these taxes and duties will be made easier by E-Taxation. Online taxing and online payment of taxes can help reduce cost and time required for physical submission of taxes. ICT can also help crosscheck the frauds and deficiencies in payment, further bringing accuracy and revenue to the Government.

3. E-Tendering - E-Tendering will include the facilities of online tendering and procurement. It will show online alerts as to new opportunities of business with the Government and also online submission of tenders and online allotment of work. It will reduce time and cost involved in the physical tendering system.

Evolution of E-Governance

- Initiatives were taken up as early as 1972 by Chile
- Prof. Stafford Beer implemented for President Allende of Chile, the first governance software that would help the government survive a severe crisis.
- Major contribution by US Vice President Al Gore in early 1990s, which rooted worldwide in the information superhighway.
- Widespread in US, UK, Canada, Australia and India
- Focus largely on development of infrastructure such as fiber-optic networks.
- Concept of Information Society or Knowledge Society evolved
- E-governance came into a formalized and focused manner with partial success to implement Information System in the government departments and public organizations.
- During 1980s and 90s, govt. all over the world lagged behind the commercial world in accepting and implementing ICT.
- Commercial and industrial world went far ahead all over the world in harnessing the potential of ICT in their core and peripheral activities. They used ICT to reach out to their customers and business partners, thereby impressively enhancing their quality, speed and convenience.

- Visible success cases of use of ICT
 - ATM services
 - 24 hour call center
 - E-Shopping
- Software export increase (banking, financial, aviation, industrial sector from India, Ireland, Israel, China)
- 1990s and 2000 - Development of ITES (IT enabled Society)
 - Resulted in remote services like call centers, data entry

Point to be noted - All the above-mentioned services are not e-Governance service.

- Government last in the queue of institutions providing IT services.
- Initial Efforts in E-governance:
 - Partial automation of existing paper bases manual process
 - Did not result in significant Business Reengineering Process compared to private sector
 - No big changes seen in government enterprises
 - May be because of
 - Conservatism
 - Resistance to change
 - Rigidity of legislative body
- Major issues that has become highly relevant for large-scale implementation of ICT in governance
 - Issue of Security
 - Privacy
 - Vulnerability (exposure) of public ICT infrastructure to crime
- Potential to abuse, terrorism and general crime
- Problems in social cohesion
 - Social Exclusion --- digital divide

UN e-Government Readiness Index

There are several international rankings of e-government maturity. *The Eurostat rankings, Economist, Brown University, and the UN e-Government Readiness Index are among the most frequently cited.* The United Nations Public Administration Network conducts a bi-annual e-

Government survey, which includes a section titled *e-Government Readiness*. It is a comparative ranking of the countries of the world according to two primary indicators:

1. i) the state of e-government readiness; and
2. ii) the extent of e-participation.

The following is the list of the top 15 countries according to the UN's 2012 e-Government Readiness Index.

Rank	Country	Index
1	Republic of Korea	0.9283
2	Netherlands	0.9125
3	United Kingdom	0.8960
4	Denmark	0.8889
5	United States	0.8687
6	France	0.8635
7	Sweden	0.8599
8	Norway	0.8593
9	Finland	0.8505
10	Singapore	0.8474
11	Canada	0.8430
12	Australia	0.8390
13	New Zealand	0.8381
14	Liechtenstein	0.8264
15	Switzerland	0.8134

Present global trends of growth in E-Governance

- According to press reports during the end of 2002
 - Indicate a trend of global growth in e-governance utilization
 - Adults using Internet worldwide increase by 15% according to the findings of Second Government Online Study published by Taylor and Nelson.
 - 3 out of 10 citizens (30%) access government services online compared with only a quarter (26%) in 2001
- Government online services mostly used for
 - Search Information (24%)
 - Download Information (11%)
 - Increase in % to search info – 20% to 24% from Sep 2001 to Sep 2002
- Globally, online government transactions increased from just 6% to 7% during 2001 and 2002 and the percentage of those providing personal details to government increased from 7% to 8%
- E governance usage in different countries (between 2001-2002)
 - Australia – significant increase from 31% to 46%
 - Turkey – 3% to 13%
 - Netherlands – 32% 41%
 - US – 34% to 43%
 - Japan – decrement by 4% - 17% to 13%
- In 2001, security issue was the main concern which improved globally in 2002.
- 2001 – 14% felt secured with credit card and bank account numbers
- 2002 – this increased to 23%
- Highest levels of safety was seen in the Scandinavian Market (Denmark, Finland, Norway and Sweden) together with some South East Asian markets (Singapore and Hong Kong)- around 1/3 of users felt safe.
- In contrast- 90% of Japanese felt accessing online services unsafe.
- Germany 82% and France 76% - unsafe

Other Key Findings

- Governance online service is more dominant to men (33%) than women (26%)
- 2001 – 2002 - Subsequent rise in government online usage among
 - 35-44 years old (22% to 36%)
 - 55-64 years old (2% to 18%)
 - 65 years and above (7% in 2001 and 5% in 2002)
- Globally, no. of people making government transaction online = people making online shopping transaction
- 15% of Internet users have made online government transactions and in addition 15% have made an online purchase at least during that year.
- Only 16% users in Hungary access government online services while its 81% in Norway
- In countries like Singapore, Norway and Sweden – high usage of online government services as the citizens feel comfortable with this approach of dealing with the government
- In Britain, New Zealand and South Korea – usage of government online services lags behind the normal Internet usage
- All the above statistics on usage of e-governance services is time bound. Over the years, there has been a definite rise in the usage of e-governance all over the world.

NEWS : Nepal slips on e-government development indicator

Although the government touts it is keenly focusing on the development of Information Communication Technology, particularly e-governance, Nepal has slipped 11 positions and landed on 164th position in global ranking of 193 countries on e-government development, according to a survey of United Nations Public Administration Network. The network, which published its report on e-Government Survey 2012, says Nepal was ranked 153rd position in a similar survey in 2010. The drop in rank suggests the government of Nepal is still not efficiently using the ICT tools to deliver public services.

The survey ranks UN member countries based on E-Government Development Index, which is a composite indicator that measures the willingness and capacity of national administrations to use information and communication technologies to deliver public services.

The government of the Republic of Korea retained first position earned in 2010. Likewise, Netherlands and the United Kingdom became second and third most advanced e-government in the world respectively. Denmark, the United States and France are among top five leaders in e-government.

Among South Asian countries, Maldives is ranked highest (at 95th position) for adopting e-governance. Like Nepal, India too slipped down five spots this year and was ranked at 124th position. Sri Lanka and Bangladesh are ranked 115th and 134th respectively.

The report states that countries like Israel and Luxembourg have entered in top 20 investing considerable resources in e-government in the last few years.

The score of Nepal in online services is 0.28 out of 1, similar to that of 2010. According to the report, Nepal scored just 0.026 in e-participation and it had scored 0.05 in previous survey. Similarly, India scored 0.18 in e-participation and its score in 2010 was 0.20.

E-Governance Initiatives in Nepal

Key e-governance initiatives in Nepal include:

- **The National e-Governance Master Plan:** This plan, which was first developed in **2006**, provides a roadmap for the development of e-governance in Nepal. The plan has been updated several times over the years to reflect the changing needs of the country.
- **The Digital Nepal Framework:** This framework, which was launched in **2019**, sets out a vision for Nepal as a digitally enabled country. The framework identifies five key pillars for achieving this vision: digital infrastructure, digital literacy, digital government, digital entrepreneurship, and digital society.
- **The National Identity Card (NIC):** The NIC is a multi-purpose card that can be used to access a wide range of government and private sector services. The NIC was first rolled out in **2014**, and it is now used by over 10 million people.
- **The Government Online Payment Gateway (GOPG):** The GOPG is a secure online payment platform that allows citizens to pay for government services online. The GOPG was launched in **2018**, and it has now been used to make over 1 million payments.
- **The National Data Center (NDC):** The NDC is a secure data storage facility that houses the government's core data assets. The NDC was established in **2019**, and it is designed to provide a secure and reliable platform for the storage and management of government data.

Challenges to e-governance in Nepal

Despite the progress that has been made, there are still a number of challenges to e-governance in Nepal. These challenges include:

- **Limited access to ICT:** Many Nepalis do not have access to the internet or other ICT tools. This makes it difficult for them to access e-governance services.
- **Lack of digital literacy:** Many Nepalis are not familiar with ICT tools and how to use them. This can make it difficult for them to take advantage of e-governance services.
- **Cybersecurity threats:** E-governance systems are vulnerable to cyberattacks. This is a major concern for the government, as a cyberattack could disrupt government services and cause significant damage to the economy.